

Lesson 10

REVIEW LESSONS 06 - 09



Warm-up

IT LINGO DECODER

Instructions: Fill in the missing letters in the boxes to identify the word being described in each number.

1. The physical components of a computer system

H			D				E
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2. Programs and operating information used by a computer

		F	T				E
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3. To find and fix problems in a computer system

T	R			B	L						T
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4. The basic structure of a computer system, including hardware and software

	T		I					S	T		U				E
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5. Protective measures to prevent unauthorized access to a computer network

		T	W	O						C	U				
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6. To restart a computer system

	E				T
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Discussion:

- What problems can happen in business communication with international colleagues?
- Do people communicate the same way in every culture? Can you give an example?
- What is one thing you've learned about communication from working in a diverse team?
- How do you usually ask for help when there's a technical problem?
- What are some good ways to check understanding in a business conversation?



Practice

1. Discussion: Cross-Cultural Scenarios - What Would You Do?

In small groups, read short descriptions of cultural situations that happen during international IT projects. Your task is to discuss:

- **What could be the cultural issue here?**
- **How would you respond professionally?**

Scenario 1:

You're on a Zoom call with your new client in Japan. After presenting your proposal, you ask if they agree. They respond with silence and a slight smile.

- What might this mean? What should you do next?

Scenario 2:

You send a detailed 8-paragraph email to a colleague in the U.S. They reply with one sentence.

- Are they being rude? How would you follow up?

Scenario 3:

During a daily Scrum meeting, your colleague from Sweden openly criticizes a bug you missed.

- How would you react constructively?

2. Debate: What's the Best Way to Communicate?

Work in small groups and join in a debate:

Debate Topic: “In business, being direct is better than being polite.”

- When is direct communication helpful or necessary?
- Can polite language sometimes cause confusion?
- What do different cultures expect in feedback?
- Is it possible to be both clear and respectful?

Instructions:

- Choose your side: **Agree** or **Disagree**.
- In your group, prepare **2–3 arguments** to support your opinion.
- Introduce your group's opinion and take turns sharing your ideas.

Useful phrases:

- **To give your opinion:** *I believe that...; In my experience...; I think email is better because...*
- **To disagree politely:** *I see your point, but...; I'm not sure I agree with that; Another way to look at it is...;*
- **To support your point:** *For example...; One reason is...; This is especially true when...*



Production

ROLE-PLAY: TECHNICAL SUPPORT ACROSS CULTURE

Instructions:

1. **Form pairs** – one student plays **Tech Support (A)**, the other plays **Client (B)**.
2. Choose a scenario (or rotate through all three).
3. Read the **scenario brief** and understand the **technical issue** and **cultural element** involved.
4. Role-play the support call using appropriate language and tone. Switch roles after completing one scenario.

Scenario 1: Software Installation Glitch

Technical Problem: The client is receiving error messages while trying to install new software.

Cultural Element: The client comes from a culture where direct questions are seen as impolite.

Support Focus: Be patient and use indirect or polite questioning to gather details. Provide clear, step-by-step instructions.

Scenario 2: Network Connectivity Issues

Technical Problem: The client is experiencing intermittent internet connection, affecting their ability to work.

Cultural Element: The client is from a culture with high levels of formality.

Support Focus: Use formal language and maintain a professional, respectful tone while troubleshooting.

Scenario 3: Delayed System Update

Technical Problem: The client's system is running slowly due to a missed system update.

Cultural Element: The client values efficiency and time very highly and is becoming frustrated.

Support Focus: Stay calm and empathetic. Be concise, solution-focused, and reassuring.

Discussion:

- What challenges did you encounter when trying to balance technical support with cultural sensitivity?
- How does this activity relate to real-life situations where you've interacted with someone from a different cultural background?



Homework

Cross-Cultural Communication (Speaking/Discussion Preparation)

Scenario: You will have a virtual meeting with your international colleagues to discuss the project.

Task: Prepare a short list (5 points) of potential cultural norms and communication styles that you should be aware of. Consider formality levels and whether a direct versus indirect approach is appropriate. Note down how you would adapt to different cultures to avoid misinterpretations. Use at least 3 vocabulary words and 3 phrases from lesson 8 and 9